- The graph also captures semantic relationships between resource types, like tickets, project plans, and other documents.

Figure 6.1 provides a snapshot of this relationship graph, illustrating employees, customers, and resources along with the relationships that govern access.

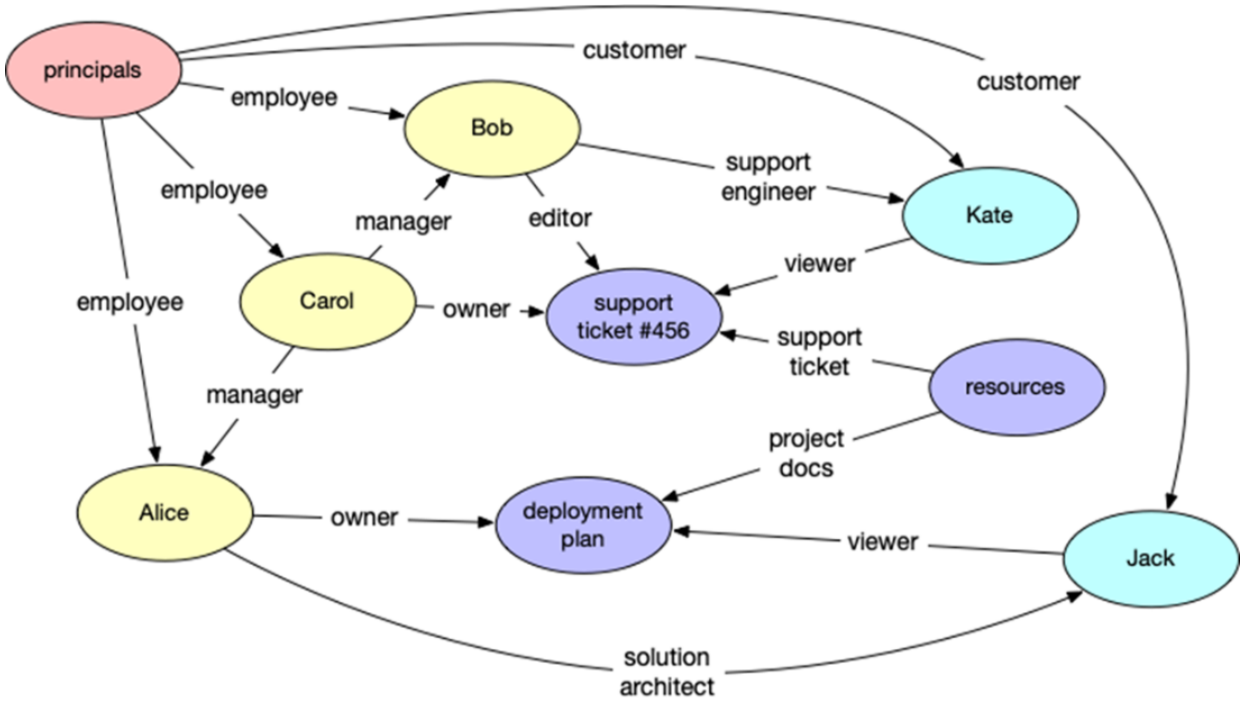


Figure 6.1 A relationship graph used by ACME Corp's Customer Collaboration platform. Employees like Bob and Alice are linked to customer accounts through roles such as support engineer and solution architect. Access to resources like support tickets and deployment plans is controlled by these relationships, allowing for dynamic, fine-grained authorization decisions based on who is connected to what and how.

ReBAC systems determine access by traversing this type of graph. Instead of assigning permissions directly, they verify whether a path exists between a principal and a resource that meets a policy condition, such as viewer of a document, owner of a ticket, or manager of an owner. These paths can be short and straightforward or more complex, involving multiple relationship hops to represent business logic. This graph model makes it easier to manage delegated access, shared ownership, and team-based collaboration across organizational boundaries.